Holiday Tipping Checklist 2026

Emily Post Institute suggestions, with a budget and a given column

BEFORE YOU GIVE

☐ Suggestions only; stay within your personal budget	Set your budget
☐ Some employers bar cash or gifts	Check employer rules
☐ Add a short handwritten note of appreciation	Write a note

BUILDING

☐ $15-$80, or $15 or more each for several, or a gift	Doorman
☐ $20-$80 or a gift	Superintendent
☐ $15-$40 each	Elevator operator
☐ $10-$30 or a small gift	Garage attendant

HOME AND FAMILY

☐ Up to one week's pay and/or a small gift	Housekeeper
☐ Up to one evening's pay and a small gift from your child	Babysitter
☐ A gift, or $25-$70 per staff member	Day care staff
☐ Up to one week's pay or a gift	Dog walker
☐ No Emily Post amount; check school rules	Teacher

DELIVERY AND MAIL

☐ Non-cash gift, $20 or less	Mail carrier
☐ Small gift only, about $20, no cash	Package deliverer
☐ $10-$30 or a small gift	Newspaper delivery

My notes

Source: Emily Post Institute, Holiday Tipping Guide (suggestions, not rules); U.S. Postal Service, Current Employees - Ethics.